

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

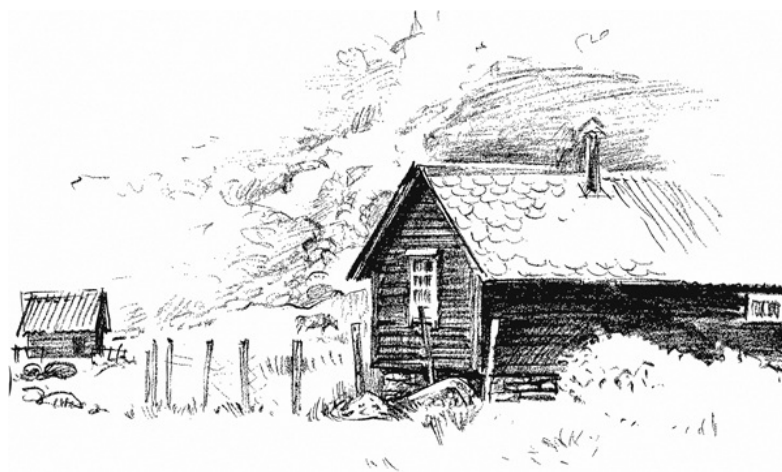
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

It was such an interesting old street!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What interesting streets have you seen in your city?
- What type of buildings are on the street?
- Who do you think lives or works there?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can say what had been happening or what had happened.
- I can report past actions or events.





Let's Explore!

Marc found a **hidden*** street.

* When a street is "hidden" it is extremely difficult to find.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Marc Girondin was believed to have worked in the filing section of the city hall's engineering department for so long that he knew every street in the city. No one else was known to have possessed such knowledge. He became the undisputed expert.

Marc had been staying at his office longer and longer because his neighbors were noisy and sometimes violent. His life, outside of work, had been becoming uncomfortable. He had continued on, of course, unhappy but hardworking as ever. He's believed to have spent his 45th birthday alone.

Then something had happened that filled him with amazement. He had discovered an old card he assumed to have been stuck at the back of a drawer for ages. It was labeled GREEN BOTTLE STREET.

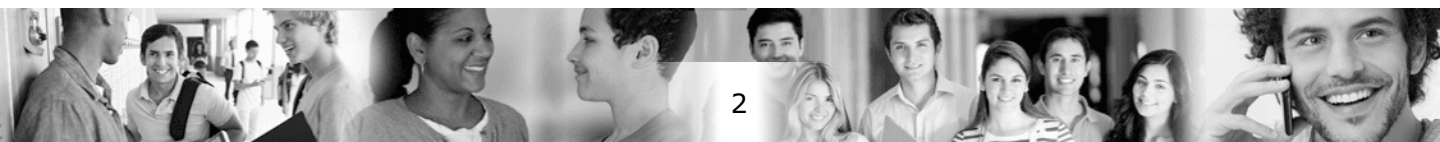
The date of the last regular street inspection had been exactly fifty years, five months and fourteen days ago. It was a lost, forgotten street. He had been hoping without hope that such a place might exist. He had been looking for a street where things might be different. The next day he had gone to look at it.

He had been looking for a while before he had found it. The street had been half hidden. He had found six small houses, each with a diminutive garden in front. Windowless brick walls of ancient warehouses had encircled them.

At first glance, Marc realized how it had gotten its unusual name. It was exactly like a bottle in shape. He was entranced! It was just the kind of place he had always wished to have lived in.

He knocked on the door to see if there was a place to rent. When the door opened a Marc explained how he had found the street. A genial Mrs. Glass said they had been waiting for someone to find them for years, but no one had. There had been no tax notices, no water or electricity bills or mail delivered for years.

The street seemed to have been mislaid as it were. Marc decided then and there that it would remain mislaid forever.





Let's Practice!

Marc is on a quest* to find the street.

*A "quest" is a long search for something.

Instructions: Circle the correct option to correctly complete the sentences.

- Marc _____ at his office longer and longer because his neighbors were noisy and sometimes violent.
a. had been staying b. has been stayed c. hadn't staying
- His life, outside of work, _____ uncomfortable.
a. have being becoming b. are becoming c. had been becoming
- He _____ on, of course, unhappy but hardworking as ever.
a. has been continued b. had be continuing c. had continued
- Then something _____ that filled him with amazement.
a. had happen b. had happened c. have happens
- He _____ without hope that such a place might exist.
a. had been hope b. had been hoping c. have hope

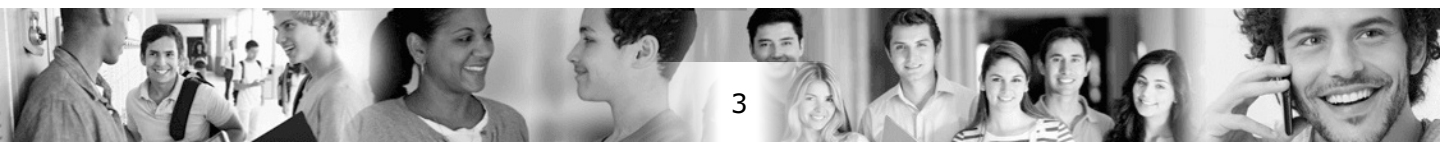


Let's Practice!

Marc isn't happy with his life.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Correct the mistake. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- Marc Girondin was believe to have worked in the filing section of the city hall's engineering department.
- No one else was known to have possessing such knowledge.
- He's believed to have spending his 45th birthday alone.
- He had discovered an old card he assumed to have been sticking at the back of a drawer for ages.
- It was just the kind of place he had always wished to have living in.
- The street seeming to have been mislaid as it were.





Extension Activity

Find a picture of an old house or a few old houses on a street.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Use the pictures of the houses to write about the people who lived there.
- Say what the people were like.
- Describe what had happened and what had been happening there.
- Read your 200-word description to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write about a picture of old houses.

☐ ☐

I describe the people who lived there using character traits.

☐ ☐

I use the Past Perfect and Past Perfect Continuous tenses.

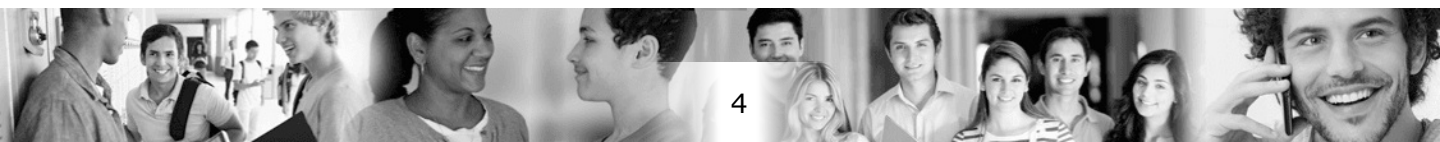
☐ ☐

I share my description with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to stick** (verb): to be fixed in position
e.g. He had discovered an old card he assumed to have been stuck at the back of a drawer for ages.
- to label** (verb): to attach material that has information about an object to that object
e.g. It was labeled GREEN BOTTLE STREET.
- inspection** (noun): careful examination or scrutiny
e.g. The date of the last regular street inspection had been exactly fifty years, five months and fourteen days ago.
- diminutive** (adjective): unusually small
e.g. He had found six small houses, each with a diminutive garden in front.
- genial** (adjective): friendly and cheerful
e.g. A genial Mrs. Glass said they had been waiting for someone to find them for years.
- as it were** (expression): in a way
e.g. The street seemed to have been mislaid, as it were.
- undisputed** (adjective): accepted
e.g. He'd become the undisputed expert.
- amazement** (noun): disbelief; speechlessness
e.g. Then something had happened that filled him with amazement.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect Continuous and Past Perfect Tenses

You use the Past Perfect Continuous to talk about an action that was in progress up to a certain point in the past. You use the Past Perfect to talk about an action that finished before a certain point in the past.

Compare these two sentences:

*I **had been finishing** some work at home when the delivery guy came by, so I didn't hear him leave the package.*

*I **had finished** all my work so I started making dinner.*

The structure of the Past Perfect Continuous is:

subject + *had* + *been* + verb+ *-ing*

When you want to refer to how many times something happened in the past before another past event, you use the Past Perfect, not the Past Perfect Continuous.

For example:

*How many times **had you seen** the movie before the award ceremony?*

*I **had stayed** in the motel twice before.*

Examples:

- *He'd become the undisputed expert.*
- *Marc had been staying at his office longer and longer because his neighbors were noisy and sometimes violent. His life, outside of work, had been becoming uncomfortable.*
- *He had continued on, of course, unhappy but hardworking as ever.*
- *Then something had happened that filled him with amazement.*
- *The date of the last regular street inspection had been exactly fifty years, five months and fourteen days ago.*
- *He had been hoping without hope that such a place might exist. He had been looking for a street where things might be different.*
- *He had been looking for a while before he had found it.*
- *A genial Mrs. Glass said they had been waiting for someone to find them for years, but no one had.*





Learning Points

Perfect Infinitives for Reporting

When you want to report an earlier event, you can use the passive voice. The passive voice puts the emphasis on the receiver of the action rather than the doer (or agent) of the action.

You use the following structure:

subject + passive report verb + perfect infinitive

For an event that happened in the past, but reported in the present, you use this structure:

*She **is believed to never have complimented** anyone.*
(They believe that she never complimented anyone)

For an event that happened in the past and is reported later in the past, you use this structure:

*She **was believed to never have complimented** anyone.*
(They believed that she never complimented anyone)

Examples:

- *Marc Girondin was believed to have worked in the filing section of the city hall's engineering department for so long that he knew every street in the city.*
- *No one else was known to have possessed such knowledge.*
- *He's believed to have spent his 45th birthday alone.*
- *He had discovered an old card he assumed to have been stuck at the back of a drawer for ages.*
- *It was just the kind of place he had always wished to have lived in.*
- *The street seemed to have been mislaid as it were.*

